



Infrastructure Services and structures such as power supply and road networks that allow society to function.

Latitude Distance from the equator. A low latitude is near the equator, and a high latitude is nearer the polar regions.

Lava Molten rock that erupts from a volcano and hardens into solid rock.

Lithosphere Earth's outer shell, consisting of the crust and the uppermost layer of the mantle.

Magma Molten rock lying beneath Earth's crust.

Mantle The deep layer of hot rock that lies between Earth's crust and the core.

Metamorphic rock
Rock changed from its original state by intense heat, pressure, or both.

Microbe A microscopic living thing.

Mid-ocean ridge A ridge of mountains on the ocean floor, created by a spreading rift between two plates of Earth's crust.

Migrate To make a regular, often yearly journey in search of food or a mate.

Mineral A natural solid made of one or more elements in fixed proportions, usually with a distinctive crystal structure.

Molecule A particle formed from a fixed number of atoms. Two hydrogen atoms joined to one oxygen atom form a water molecule.

Monsoon A seasonal change of wind that affects the weather in the Indian subcontinent and Southeast Asia, causing wet and dry seasons.

Multicellular A living thing that is made up of many cells.

Nuclear Relating to the nucleus of an atom. If the nuclei of two atoms are fused together, or a single atomic nucleus is split, this nuclear reaction releases nuclear energy.

Nucleus The central mass of something, such as an atom or a living cell. The plural is nuclei.

Nutrients
Substances that living things need to build tissue.

Oceanic crust
The relatively thin crust of basalt that lies

above Earth's mantle and forms the bedrock of the ocean floor. Oceanic crust is denser than continental crust, and always subducts beneath it.

Orbit To circle a planet or star. Earth orbits the Sun, and the Moon orbits Earth.

Ore A natural material from which valuable minerals can be extracted.

Organic A substance that is based on the element carbon, but usually meaning something that is—or was once—alive. Also, a type of farming and produce.

Organism A living thing.

Parasite An organism that lives in or on another. The relationship benefits the parasite but is detrimental to the host.

Peat The compacted remains of plants that have not fully decayed, because the oxygen vital to decay was excluded, usually because of saturation by water.

Permafrost Permanently frozen ground that covers large areas of the polar regions, especially in the Arctic.

Pesticide A chemical used to kill small animals, fungi, and weeds that attack or compete with farm crops.

Petrified Turned to stone.

Photosynthesis The process by which plants use the energy from sunlight to make sugar from carbon dioxide and water.

Phytoplankton Microscopic, single-celled organisms that drift in the sunlit surface waters of oceans and lakes and use photosynthesis to make food.

Plankton Living things that drift in lakes and oceans, usually near the surface.

Pluton A mass of igneous rock such as granite that formed below ground, but may now be exposed.

Porous A rock or similar substance that is not waterproof, and which may soak up water like a sponge.

Prevailing wind A wind that blows from a certain direction most of the time.

Protein A complex substance that a living thing makes out of simpler nutrients and uses to form its tissues.

